

Corporate gifting strategy and bundle automation

Ryan Cunningham | Texas A&M University | Client: Incentive Concepts

Our team developed a toolkit to help a corporate gifting distributor assess supplier risk and create multi-brand gift bundles more efficiently. The project connected market research and customer feedback with Excel analysis and Python automation.

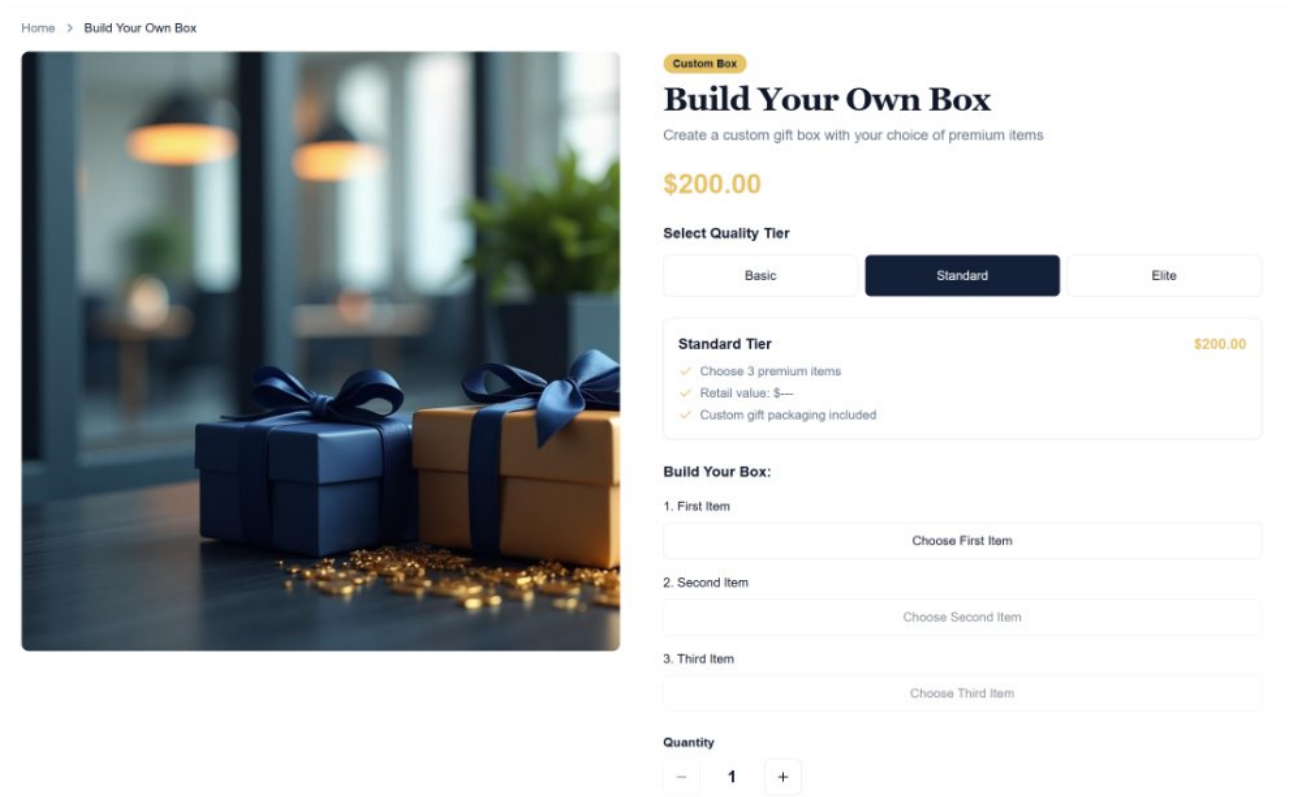


Figure 1. The client's Build Your Own Box concept, reproduced from the team's final report. This illustrates the business context; the capstone toolkit was not a live e-commerce implementation.

The business challenge

Incentive Concepts faced disintermediation as brand partners expanded direct-to-customer gifting channels. Dependence on a small number of suppliers increased its exposure. Multi-brand bundles offered a potential way to add value, but selecting products and checking margins was a manual, time-intensive process.

My role

I conducted substantial corporate gifting market research and led the customer survey and qualitative data collection. I also supported portions of the Python development. My contribution focused on connecting buyer needs and business requirements to the team's proposed solution.

From research to practical tools

The team combined competitor research, historical sales analysis, sponsor discussions, customer survey responses, and prototype testing. This helped translate a broad strategic concern into requirements for supplier risk assessment and bundle selection.

A connected analytical workflow

1. Excel risk model

Supported revenue analysis, scenario planning, and stress testing to explore supplier and customer concentration.

2. Python risk engine

Used historical brand revenue to calculate risk scores reflecting concentration and performance trends, then exported results for use in bundle evaluation.

3. Python bundle creation tool

Matched brand risk scores to product data, applied user-selected constraints, and ranked candidate bundles using margin and risk priorities. Results were exported to Excel for review.

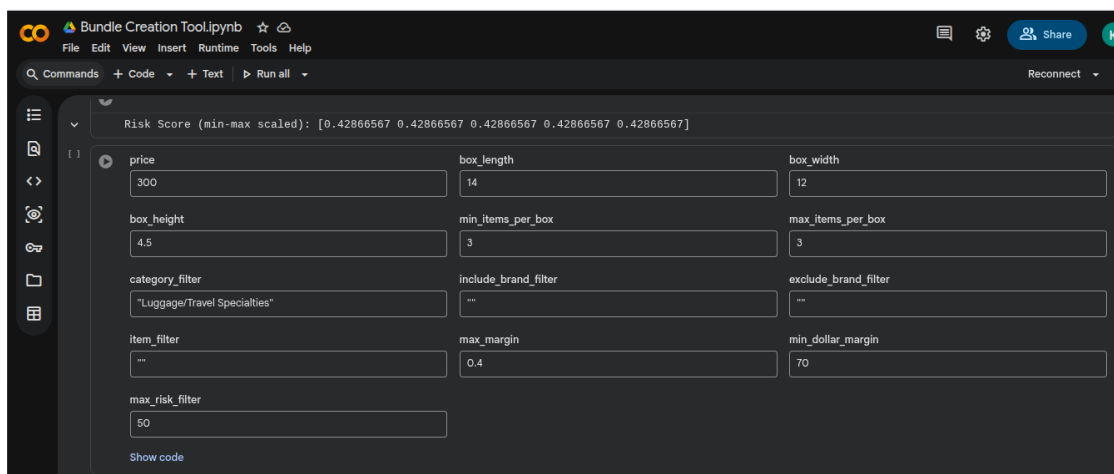


Figure 2. Bundle creation controls from the submitted final report. Users can specify price, item count, categories, brands, and other constraints. These controls do not replace packaging or compatibility checks.

Customer input

My research examined competing gifting offerings and bundling models. The survey explored gifting habits, budgets, customization, online ordering, and bundle interest to connect buyer preferences with operational requirements.

Delivery scope

The Excel model, two Python notebooks, user guide, and report formed the delivered toolkit. It used exported data without live ERP, CRM, or storefront integration.

Evidence of impact and capability

The final report describes bundle-list generation moving from approximately **3-4 hours manually to 5-10 minutes** using the tool. In the team’s comparison using matching input parameters, average proposed-bundle margin increased from **22.3% to 33.8%**.



Figure 3. Average proposed-bundle margins reported in team testing: an 11.5 percentage-point increase. These are comparison results, not realized sales or profit. Chart recreated from the final report.

Skills I demonstrated

Market research and commercial judgment - Examined industry offerings and bundling approaches to understand how a distributor could differentiate its services.

Survey design and customer discovery - Led the customer survey and qualitative data collection to explore gifting preferences and purchasing considerations.

Analytical communication - Connected research findings and customer input to the business problem, while recognizing the limits of a small survey sample.

Technical collaboration and Python support - Contributed to portions of the Python development while working within a team that delivered the broader analytical toolkit.

Team capabilities and next steps

The team’s work demonstrated Excel modeling, data preparation, Python automation, supplier risk analysis, and process improvement. Only five survey responses were received, so market demand was not established. Recommendations still required review for product appeal, packaging, compatibility, and brand restrictions. A limited customer pilot and broader buyer research would be the next steps before scaling.

Sources: Supplied team Final Report (background research, methodology, solution, benefits, and conclusion); Section A Risk Engine Model; Section B Risk Engine Tool; Section C Bundle Creation Tool; Capstone Tool Instructions. Individual responsibilities reflect Ryan Cunningham’s description of his contribution. Figures 1 and 2 are reproduced from the supplied report.